

# The Boston Globe

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## Schools lag on fighting deepfake porn

Few have policies despite complaints from victims

By Mariana Simões

GLOBE STAFF

Fake AI-generated naked images of students are making the rounds in schools across Massachusetts. For as little as \$4.99, teenagers are uploading photos of their classmates' faces to "nudify" sites to generate so-called deepfake pornographic pictures of them in an instant.

Sharing nonconsensual deepfake pictures is considered a crime under a state law passed two years ago known as the Revenge Porn Act. And yet, school administrators have not done much to stop the spread in hallways.

Across the state, teenage students, mainly girls, have increasingly found themselves the victims of deepfake nude pictures shared with classmates, a trend that could create lasting psychological damage.

Experts say schools need to get ahead of the issue by teaching students about the harm caused by the

images.

So far, only a fraction of Massachusetts school districts have policies addressing deepfakes or mandating punishments for students who create or spread them.

Last November, 14-year-old Grace Mancini was on her way to English class at Hingham Middle School when a group of girls warned her that an eighth-grade boy had made a fake AI-generated naked image of her.

The teen who created the image shared it with at least two friends. One saw it over a Snapchat call, took

a screenshot, and admitted to showing it to other peers in the hallways at school, according to an investigation conducted by the school and shared with the Globe.

Grace Mancini told her mom, Megan Mancini, who said she reported the incident to the police and filed a sexual harassment, or Title 9, complaint with the school. The teen boy admitted to creating the image in a text message to Grace Mancini and confessed the same to school officials, Megan Mancini said.

Still, the boy received no formal

AI PHOTOS, Page A10

## Trump's threats alarming experts

His disdain for rules of war could put US military in danger, they say

By Jim Puzzanghera and Tal Kopan

GLOBE STAFF

WASHINGTON — President Trump's vow to destroy Iran's "whole civilization" sent shock waves — and fears of potential war crimes — around the world, reverberations he credits with bringing about a

►Cease-fire is tested. A4.

But his threat Tuesday was far from a one-time negotiating tactic. It wasn't even his first of the week. On Easter Sunday, Trump promised to target Iran's civilian infrastructure, another action generally forbidden under the rules of war.

Trump has a long history of comments and actions that show disdain for the constraints of international law, a track record shared and often amplified by his defense secretary, Pete Hegseth.

White House press secretary Karoline Leavitt on Wednesday brushed aside questions about Trump's incendiary language, asserting it in no way ceded the moral high ground.

"What the president cares most about is results, and in fact, his very tough rhetoric and his tough negotiating style is what has led to the result that you are all witnessing today," she said. "It was a very strong threat that led to results and . . .

TRUMP, Page A6

## Supplements offer promises but not proof

Marketing fuels demand for powders amid criticism

By Alexa Gagosz

GLOBE STAFF

Every morning for about six months, Julia Britto and her husband stirred a dark green powder into water and drank it down. It was a daily ritual that promised better gut health, stronger immunity, and the "easiest way" to get their greens.

They felt they were doing something good for their bodies, especially on days when the rest of their diet wasn't exactly balanced. But after months of regular use, Britto said, she never noticed a meaningful difference.

"Some of the benefits are supposed to be with digestion and gastrointestinal benefits," said Britto, a nurse practitioner in Providence. "I didn't notice any of those at all."

The couple had been using Super Greens by Live it Up, a New York-based company founded by an MIT graduate that sells so-called superfood supplements. The product listing says it was "featured on Forbes 2026," is "third-party tested," and "science backed." A 30-day supply for one costs \$60.

Britto and her husband canceled their subscription shortly before federal regulators announced a recall on many of the company's products in January due to possible salmonella con-

SUPPLEMENTS, Page A7



SUZANNE KREITER/GLOBE STAFF

YmaNini LaCourt said Mizzo is "part of me, part of my life, part of my world." The Boston Animal Rescue League helps with food.

## Animal lovers' pet programs make difference in hard times

Food pantries for furry friends help their owners make ends meet

By Claire Thornton

GLOBE STAFF

YmaNini LaCourt wouldn't know what she would do without her dog Mizzo, a small Chihuahua-mix with an adorable underbite.

But after losing her job during the pandemic, LaCourt has been working part time for less than \$20 an hour, not nearly enough to cover her expenses, including food for a pet she describes as "part of me, part of my life, part of my world."

LaCourt, 65, is among hundreds of pet owners increasingly turning to local pet food pantries to make ends meet. As the cost of living in the Boston area continues to climb, and with recent federal cuts to programs that help low-income Americans, including SNAP and Medicaid, more people would be forced to give up their furry family members without this kind of assistance, according to the

food pantries.

"Pets are part of people's families, and we're really focused on keeping families together," said Edward Schettino, president of the Boston Animal Rescue League, which runs the Keep Pets SAFE program. SAFE stands for Supporting Animals and Families Everyday and its pantry serves pet owners in Dorchester, Mattapan, and Roxbury.

"When people struggle, pets struggle," Schettino added.

Demand for the SAFE program and a statewide equivalent run by the Massachusetts Society for the Prevention of Cruelty to Animals (MSPCA) has surged this year compared to 2025, according to the nonprofits.

When money is tight, many pet owners sacrifice their own needs to buy a bag of kibble, animal advocates said. Some may feed their pet before eating a meal themselves.

Like LaCourt, many people in Massachusetts got pets during the pandemic to keep them company while spending more time at home.

Alyssa Krieger, director of community outreach for Boston's MSPCA, said the group distributed 2.8 million pet meals across Massachusetts in 2024. In 2025, the number jumped to 3.5 million, she said.

Krieger said their clients typically get half of their pet's monthly food from the program, visiting sites such as the Lawrence YMCA, Hyde Park's Helping Plates and the Falmouth Service Center to pick up a bag of kibble provided by the MSPCA.

Pet owners seek out the program about two to four times per year, she said, and receive around \$50 worth of food each time.

"People are using it when they really, real-

PET FOOD, Page A7

## SJC weighs whether White would be a new stadium

By Sean Cotter and Niki Griswold

GLOBE STAFF

The fate of Mayor Michelle Wu's controversial bid to redevelop White Stadium in Franklin Park for a professional women's soccer team may hinge in part on whether the \$325 million project is viewed as simply a renovation of an aging facility or, for all practical matters, a brand new arena altogether.

And the answer to that seemingly fine distinction may rest on how the seven judges of the state's highest court interpret a few small words contained in the laws establishing White Stadium eight decades ago.

That was one of the salient

points of argument to emerge Wednesday when a legal challenge that Wu's soccer stadium violates state park protections went before the Supreme Judicial Court.

Among the issues the justices homed in on was whether the phrase "the stadium" contained in those old laws encompasses a new arena with a broader scope, as the Wu administration argued, or is specifically limited to the original one used exclusively for school sports teams.

Several justices pointedly questioned the city's lawyers about their definition of that phrase, "the stadium."

"It identifies a preexisting

STADIUM, Page A10



PAT GREENHOUSE/GLOBE STAFF

The justices asked pointed questions of both sides Wednesday.



Go fly a kite

Thursday: Breezy, cool. High 50-55. Low 34-39.

Friday: Warmer at last. High 61-66. Low 45-50.

Weather and Comics, D5-6.

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**Rachael Rollins, who resigned as US attorney for Massachusetts amid an ethics scandal, pulled papers to run for her old job. B1.**

**A cybersecurity incident at Brockton Hospital has forced staff to revert to paper records and analog methods. D1.**

**A Long Island architect who led a secret life as a serial killer pleaded guilty to murdering seven women and admitted that he had killed an eighth. A2.**

**The Red Sox took a series for the first time this season, stopping the Brewers for the second day in a row, this time 5-0. C1.**